“In the morning, go to the gatehouse and ask for another cabin assignment,” the woman said, patting Léa’s arm. “But for now, you take the left side, and I’ll take the right. Come, let’s sleep.”

Léa followed her to one of the rooms off the corridor. Inside was pitch-black, so the woman took Léa’s hand and guided her to the far end. Grimacing, she removed her dirty shoes and reached out her hand until she touched the bed’s cold metal frame. She crawled on the mattress, careful with her knee, the straw filling poking through the thin sheet, rough against her skin. Edith’s presence reminded her of Rose, though the sisters hadn’t shared a bed since the boardinghouse, as they had separate rooms at the LeBlanc’s home. She hoped Rose was safe, and neither she nor Virginie would be implicated in the smuggling.

Closing her eyes, she tried not to think about the future. It was too far ahead. She’d ask for another cabin at the gatehouse. Once she had a bed, she’d know what to do. In daylight, things would be clear.

* * *

Léa awakened to a bell clanking outside. She sat up. The room was empty, Edith gone. Rubbing her eyes, she carried her shoes and made her way out to the corridor and the main room she’d been in the night before.

The sun shone bright through the filthy window. She saw a few women sitting on a bench in front of the cabin. Not far from them, young children held hands as they spun in a circle, laughing. The barbed-wire fence stood in the distance like tiny cathedral spires.

She put on her shoes and opened the door; her knee throbbed as she went down the steps. She looked for Edith, wanting to thank her for last night, but couldn’t see her. Walking away from the cabins and children playing, she got her first glimpse of the enormity of the camp and the strands of wire twisting in layers with barbs at regular intervals and supported by tall wooden poles with lights that she’d seen last night. At the far end, cordoned off with barbed wire, stood a building with women milling around outside.

Léa found the toilets, four stalls in a stinking wooden building behind the cabins, and waited in line until it was her turn. The stench in the stall made her retch. It was a simple hole in the ground, no plumbing. If the men